

The new version of digiKam 4.13.0 releases with 30 bug fixes

Developers have released the new maintenance version of digiKam; digiKam Software Collection 4.13.0 is now available for download. digiKam, which happens to be an important image manipulation software for KDE/Qt desktop environments, has apparently been released with many new features and almost 30 bug fixes.

"The digiKam team is proud to announce the release of digiKam Software Collection 4.13.0. This release is the result of another huge bugs triage on KDE Bugzilla, where more than 30 files have been closed," said the company's official release.



According to the reports, the development cycle of digiKam will be complete with the release of its last maintenance version, which is to be out by October 2015. It's also reported that digiKam 5.0.0, which would be introduced in the next release, might be ported to KDE Frameworks 5. Tech enthusiasts can download digiKam Software Collection 4.14.0 from the official site. Meanwhile, GNU/Linux users can have a look at the updates through their distribution's main software repositories.

Facebook said, "After seeing so much internal use of Hack Codegen for diverse applications, it's our pleasure to open source this library for the external community to use."

"It is interesting that we are getting back into automated code generation which was a big deal in a different era. Codegen is a valuable new tool that can help developer productivity in the right settings. The issues for automated code generation have typically been learning the abstraction itself, and then the ability to accommodate changes in the generated code. Newer technologies are constantly innovating around these issues," it added.

Google, Microsoft, Netflix and Cisco join hands to design an open source video format

Seven technology giants—Amazon, Cisco, Google, Intel, Microsoft, Mozilla and Netflix—have come together to create an open source video format. The new project aims to aid the development of new formats, technologies and codecs. The new open source video format will facilitate viewing of UHD videos and other such media over the Web.

These seven tech giants will combine their expertise, with the aim of meeting online demand for high quality audio, video, images and streaming on various devices across the globe.

According to a blog post made by the alliance, the priorities they have set include:

- Being interoperable and open
- Optimised for the Web
- Scalable to any modern device at any bandwidth
- Designed with a low computational footprint and optimised for hardware
- Capable of consistent, highest-quality, real-time video delivery
- Flexible for both commercial and non-commercial content, including user-generated content

With this project, the companies plan to build an 'open, royalty-free video codec specification, with binding specifications for media format, content encryption and adaptive streaming to accommodate upcoming new media types.'

Mozilla CTO David Bryant explained in a blog post, "One of the biggest challenges in developing open standards in a field like video codecs is figuring out how to review the patents. The Alliance provides a venue for us to share the legal legwork without having to worry about it being used against us down the road."

"That distributes the load, allows us to innovate faster and cheaper, and gives everyone more confidence that we are really producing a royalty-free codec," he added.

The Alliance for Open Media is a project of the Joint Development Foundation, an independent non-profit organisation that provides the corporate and legal infrastructure to enable groups to establish and operate standards and source code development collaborations.

Calligra 2.9.7 released with Kexi and Krita improvements

Calligra 2.9.7 is now available as a free update to all open source office suite users. Supposedly the last maintenance release in the 2.9 series, version 2.9.7 brings a lot of improvements to the Kexi and Krita components. Apart from the fixes, it also comes with various new eye-catching features. The new version of Calligra enables its users to set a default paragraph style. It comes with optimised formatting of table cells and enhanced memory usage.